central government with active support from state governments is providing comprehensive services to persons with disabilities through setting up of District Disability Rehabilitation Centers in all the unserved districts of the country. The scheme for setting up of DDRCs was initiated in Ninth Five Year Plan and is continuing in Eleventh Five Year Plan. Hundred new DDRCs were targeted to be set up during the last two years (2010-11 and 2011-12) of the Eleventh Five Year Plan.

Social Defence

Under the social defence sector, schemes/programmes are implemented for senior citizens and for victims of substance (drug) abuse.[12] Programmes for *senior citizens* aim at the welfare and maintenance especially of indigent senior citizens. For *victims* of substance abuse, drug demand reduction is achieved through awareness campaigns and treatment of addicts and their detoxification so that they may join the mainstream. Under the Integrated Programme for Older Persons (IPOP), grants-in-aid are given to NGOs for running old age homes (OAH), day care centres (DCCs), and mobile medical units (MMUs). The Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act 2007 was enacted in order to ensure need-based maintenance for parents and welfare measures for senior citizens. States/ UTs are required to implement the Act by notifying the same in the official gazette. The Act has been notified by 23 states and all the UTs so far. Besides, grants-in-aid are provided to NGOs for running integrated rehabilitation centers for addicts, regional resource and training centers, and other projects. For effective implementation of social defence programmes, personnel engaged in delivery of services in this area are being trained under various programmes being organised by the National Institute of Social Defence (NISD).

There are also different financial institutions to further the cause of upliftment of the weaker sections of society. The National Scheduled Castes Finance and Development Corporation (NSCFDC), National Safai Karamcharis Finance and Development Corporation (NSKFDC), National Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation (NBCFDC), and National Handicapped Finance and Development Corporation (NHFDC)